

Asian CHI Symposium: Decolonizing Technology Design in Asia

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ABSTRACT

The Asian CHI symposium is an annual event organized by researchers and practitioners in the Asia Pacific since the authors first co-initiated South East Asia Computer-Human Interaction (SEACHI) during CHI 2015 [1]. The symposium aims to bring together both early-career and senior HCI academia and UX practitioners from industries in the Asia Pacific and bring about cross-exchange of information and transfer of knowledge in a multidisciplinary environment and multi-socio-economic aspects of HCI research, foster social ties and collaboration in the field of HCI [2]. As the Asian CHI community grows to be more diverse than when we started in 2015, there is a need to address the issues of equity, justice, access, and transparency more strategically, especially with a historical link to colonialism in Asia. Beyond showcasing the latest Asian-inspired HCI work and those focusing on incorporating Asian sociocultural factors in their design, implementation, evaluation, and improvement, the Asian CHI Symposium 2022 is a sandbox for decolonizing yet academically rigorous discourse platform for both HCI academic and UX practitioners to present their latest research findings and solutions that reflect the expansion of HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse audiences in Asia.

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1 INTRODUCTION

The field of Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) uses insights on how social, cultural, economic, and political identities shape the way people interact with technologies. While the Global North researchers have mainly been instrumental in developing HCI, the Asian counterparts contribute by exploring a variety of applied research directions, expanding the HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse Asian cultures and societies [3]. Despite its emerging contribution towards the HCI body of knowledge, the relatively small and nascent HCI research community in Asia faces the challenges of underrepresentation,

marginalization, inequality, and colonization. Rather than recognizing the diversity of Asian cultures and societies, many international HCI events often impose on many aspects that result in a virtual barrier for Asian HCI researchers to participate in a positive and engaging space. The use of English as the unofficial research language and publication, relatively high financial requirements for publication and participation in international HCI events, time zone differences, and lack of observation for religious customs are some limiting factors that we have learned for the last seven years since 2015–2021 [4–10]. Thus, it has become urgent to provide a decolonizing yet academically rigorous discourse platform for both HCI academic and UX practitioners to present their latest research findings and solutions that reflect the expansion of HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse audiences in Asia.

To this end, there have been several symposiums organized by the authors, who are also the Permanent Steering Committee of the Asian CHI Symposium [11], at the CHI conference since 2015. These symposia include Asia-Pacific CHI Symposium (later called SEACHI), Chinese CHI Symposium, Japanese CHI Symposium (see Table 1). However, despite consistent efforts in growing diversity in the main and specialized conferences, research from Asia is still under-represented [12].

HCI in Asia is beyond research, as the researchers do not just pursue the knowledge but also apply and translate the work in the community. At CHI 2022, we will continue the success of previous Asian CHI symposiums by organizing another symposium event with more Asian research leaders across Asia to showcase a collection of HCI works that reflect the expansion of HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse audiences in Asia. This symposium will become a sandbox for decolonizing yet academically rigorous discourse platforms for both HCI academic and UX practitioners to present their latest research findings and solutions that reflect the expansion of HCI theory and applications towards culturally inclusive design for diverse audiences in Asia.

The symposium aims to bring about equal and fair access for anyone to exchange information and transfer knowledge in this multidisciplinary environment and multi-socioeconomic aspects of research and practice of HCI and UX in Asia, aligning with the CHI 2022's commitment to "Equity, Justice and Access".

2 EXPECTED OUTCOMES AND MEASUREMENTS

Our main objectives and key results (OKRs) can be derived as follows. Importantly, it accommodates a fully virtual model to face unprejudicial due to COVID19 travel restrictions and hygienic concerns.

- We aim for the number of participants to be about 30.

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Table 1: Timeline of HCI venues for Asian community at CHI from 2015-present

Year	Asia Community at CHI
2015	Crossing HCI in the Asia Pacific [4, 13], Chinese CHI Symposium and Japanese CHI Symposium
2016	Japanese CHI Symposium; Chinese CHI Symposium; SEACHI [5, 14]
2017	Asian CHI Symposium; Chinese CHI Symposium [6]
2018	Asian CHI Symposium [7, 15]; Chinese CHI Workshop
2019	Asian CHI Symposium [8, 16]; HCI in China Workshop
2020	Asian CHI Symposium [9, 17]; Chinese CHI Workshop
2021	Asian CHI Symposium [10, 18]; From the Margins to the Centre: Defining New Mission and Vision for HCI Research in South Asia

- We aim to have at least 40% of the participants being young researchers (students and early-career researchers);
- We will continue the shepherding of near-acceptance submissions, which provide ample opportunities for inexperienced researchers to upgrade their publication to a quality level. The shepherding process will be systematically designed to track the pre and post qualities of the papers selected for shepherding. With this, we aim to see significant development in quality enhancement difference in the ratings of all shepherded submissions pre-and post-shepherding (for details, see the Call for Participation section);
- We aim to have more participants from more Asian countries, especially from Southern and Western Asia geography with aggressive ambassador programs, than in the past.

3 SYMPOSIUM DAY AND STRUCTURE

The symposium will be conducted as an online event. We expect 30 participants will attend the Asian CHI Symposium online. We will limit the number of accepted submissions so that we can hold the symposium over one day. Having the symposium on Saturday allows a gap day before the main conference begins.

3.1 Oral Presentations

With the new norm, all authors with accepted submissions are expected to present their works using online presentations on a virtual platform. There will be a “prime time” slot for each work in which its authors are expected to be presenting the work to the audience.

Having learned from the 2021 symposium, we will use the online conferencing tool provided by the CHI workshop committee. In addition to that, we will also include the Slack platform to facilitate further discussions. We will collect the pre-recorded videos from the accepted position paper presenters and play them during the session to avoid network-related issues. However, the authors will answer the questions from the audience online after their presentation.

3.2 Plenary and Keynote Speeches

In the plenary session, we will invite esteemed speakers who work in the Asian regions or Asian-related projects to inspire the Asian community. Each talk will be 30 minutes, including Q&A.

4 PRE-SYMPOSIUM PLANS

We will set up a website that will host the call for papers and future programs, as well as to share the missions and the process of organizing the symposium. It will serve as an organizational memory for future organizers. We will promote the symposium actively on Facebook, Twitter as well as mailing lists related to SIGCHI activity postings. Before the symposium, we will use the Slack channel for announcements among the registered attendees for icebreaking and speed-networking.

5 POST-SYMPOSIUM PLANS

After the symposium, we will assess the attainment of our expected outcomes and share them with the rest of the community (see section Expected Outcomes and Measurements).

5.1 Publication

Original submissions that are accepted to present may choose to have their camera-ready submissions listed in the ACM Digital Library as abstract-only, the whole extended abstract, or none. These options provide enough flexibility for work-in-progress submissions so that they can continue their work, and have it published later in a journal or conference. For authors who will choose to publish their whole extended abstracts, there is a shepherding post-symposium: selected mentors will closely work with authors to improve the quality of the manuscript. Only submissions that successfully go through the shepherding will be added to the ACM Digital Library.

For the showcase submissions (that will also be presented in other CHI 2021 tracks or other published HCI materials), their entry in the symposium proceedings will contain only the title and authors with a pointer to the corresponding entry in the CHI 2022 Proceedings or Extended Abstract Proceedings.

6 ORGANIZERS

Dr Masitah Ghazali is an Associate Professor at the School of Computing, a member of ViCubeLab Research Group, and an IT Associate Fellow at UTM Digital Department at Universiti Teknologi Malaysia (UTM). She currently works on mobile-BCI to make it more accessible to people. She is one of the founding members of the ACM Kuala Lumpur Chapter and served as Chair for two consecutive terms. She currently holds the advisor position.

Dr Eunice Sari is the CEO and the Co-founder of UX Indonesia. She is a University Research Fellow of Charles Darwin University Australia. Currently, she is the ACM SIGCHI VP for Chapters and part of the Asian Development Committee for Southeast Asia. As a practitioner, Eunice is also a Google Developer Mentor in Product Design and Strategy where she leads several global UX projects.

Josh (Adi) Tedjasaputra is a Google-certified Design Sprint Master who builds and nurtures business and innovation at UX Indonesia and Customer Experience Insight Pty Ltd. For more than 20 years, he has been helping international companies in creating business strategy, disruptive technology, marketing, and branding of successful products and services.

7 CALL FOR PARTICIPATION

The Asian CHI Symposium invites the latest and original HCI research papers from Asian countries and those focusing on incorporating Asian sociocultural factors in their design and implementation. The symposium aims to promote its unique problems and approaches to the global community. We invite young and senior researchers and practitioners in this symposium.

7.1 Submission

This year we welcome two types of submissions: (1) Original Works and (2) Showcase. The Original Work highlights novel works in the form of (1) completed studies or systems, (2) preliminary results, or (3) an extension or a discussion of an alternative perspective of previously published work. These submissions can either be in the form of (1) paper (pages must be between 5-10 pages including references and acknowledgment), or (2) poster or demo (up to 4 pages including references and acknowledgment) in CHI 2022 Extended Abstract format.

The Showcase are works that will be presented at other CHI 2021 tracks, other published HCI materials. They could be presented at the symposium to broaden the dissemination of high-quality published research and to inspire applications, replications, continuation, spin-offs, and collaboration. All types of submissions are not anonymized and uploaded through the symposium website.

7.2 Review Process

Each original submission will receive two anonymized reviews. The submissions under the showcase category will be curated by considering the following factors: the number of the accepted original submissions; the geographical diversity of the attendees; and the diversity of research topics. The symposium submission process allows all authors to get feedback to improve their research before presenting it in the symposium.

7.3 Shepherd Process

On occasions when reviewers point out prominent research with empirical evidence yet have not reached the level of quality required for the publication, a shepherding process begins with the interest of the author to resubmit an improved paper. In order to improve the paper, shepherding reviewers will be assigned to the paper to advise and monitor changes based on the requirement and finally aid authors to outcome a quality research publication.

7.4 Registration

At least one author of each accepted submission must be registered for either physical or remote attendance and presentation. All participants, both authors, and audience must register for the Asian CHI Symposium as defined by the CHI 2022 committee.

7.5 Website

The symposium website is using the URL <https://asianchi.net>.

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